DVWA SETUP + PRACTICAL (Reflected & Stored XSS)

PART 1 — Installing & Configuring DVWA

Step 1: Install XAMPP

1. Download XAMPP from: https://www.apachefriends.org
2. Install it with default settings.
3. Open **XAMPP Control Panel**.
4. Start:
   - 🟢 **Apache**
   - 🟢 **MySQL**

Both should turn green.

Step 2: Download DVWA

1. Download DVWA from GitHub: https://github.com/digininja/DVWA
2. Extract the downloaded ZIP file.
3. Copy the folder **DVWA** to:

```
C:\xampp\htdocs\
```

You will now have:

```
C:\xampp\htdocs\DVWA\
```

Step 3: Create the DVWA Database in phpMyAdmin

1. Open your browser and go to:

```
http://localhost/phpmyadmin/
```

2. Click **Databases**.
3. Create a new database named:

```
dvwa
```

Press **Create**.

Step 4: Create MySQL User "dvwa"

1. In phpMyAdmin, go to **User accounts → Add user account**.
2. Fill the details:

- Username: `dvwa`
- Host: `localhost`
- Password: (set one or leave empty)
- Re-type password

3. Under **Global Privileges**, click **Check All**.
4. Click **Go**.

This creates the MySQL user DVWA requires.

Step 5: Configure DVWA (config.inc.php)

1. Go to:

```
C:\xampp\htdocs\DVWA\config\
```

2. Find:

```
config.inc.php.dist
```

3. **Rename** it to:

```
config.inc.php
```

4. Open it in Notepad.
5. Edit these values:

```
define( 'DB_HOST', 'localhost' );
define( 'DB_NAME', 'dvwa' );
define( 'DB_USER', 'dvwa' );
define( 'DB_PASS', '' );   // Put your password here if you set one
define( 'DB_PORT', 3306 );
```
Save the file.

Step 6: Setup DVWA

Open:
`http://localhost/DVWA/setup.php`
Click:
`Create / Reset Database`
You'll see:
"Database successfully created!"
DVWA is now installed.

Step 7: Login to DVWA

Open:
`http://localhost/DVWA/login.php`
Default login:

- **Username:** `admin`
- **Password:** `password`

Click **Login**.
You will reach the **DVWA Home Page**.

Step 8: Set Security Level to LOW

1. From left menu: click **DVWA Security**.
2. Select:

```
Security Level: Low
```

3. Click **Submit**.

This allows vulnerabilities to work (necessary for practicals).

PART 2 — Perform Practical No. 6 (XSS)

Practical 6: Simulate Persistent (Stored) XSS

Step 9: Test Reflected XSS (Example Already Given)

1. Click **XSS (Reflected)** from the left menu.
2. In the input box, enter:

```
"><script>alert('how are u')</script>
```

3. Click **Submit**.

Output:
A popup alert appears — this is **reflected XSS**.

Step 10: Open Stored XSS Page

1. From the left menu, click:

```
XSS (Stored)
```

You will see two input fields:

- Name
- Message

Step 11: Insert Stored XSS Payload

In **Message**, enter:

```
<script>alert('Stored XSS Working!')</script>
```

In **Name**, enter any name, e.g.:

```
John
```

Click **Sign Guestbook / Submit**.

Step 12: Observe the Result

When the page reloads:

- The script is **saved into the database**.
- A popup **automatically appears**.

This is **Stored XSS**, because the JavaScript is stored in the database and executed every time the page loads.

Step 13: Refresh the Page

Press **F5**.
The popup appears **again**.
This confirms **persistent (stored) XSS**.

YOU HAVE COMPLETED THE PRACTICAL!